DIGITAL LITERACY REPORT FILE

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Course	(NGMC) Digital Literacy

Introduction

In today's digital age, the ability to use technology effectively and responsibly has become an essential skill. Digital literacy is not only important for academic success but also for professional growth and safe participation in the online world. This project was undertaken as part of the Digital Literacy course to develop a better understanding of various digital tools, platforms, and practices.

The project consists of five tasks that focus on key areas such as creating digital content, building a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, understanding email etiquette, and raising awareness about cybercrime. Each task provided practical exposure and helped in developing essential skills required in the modern digital environment.

Overall, this project aims to promote responsible digital behavior and prepare students to navigate the digital world effectively.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I used **Canva** to design a one-page infographic titled "Digital Literacy: Your Survival Guide in the Online World." Canva is a free, browser-based design tool that offers ready-made templates, icons, and layout options, which made it easy to create a visually appealing resource without any prior design experience.

My infographic covers three key topics from the module. First, it explains what digital literacy is — the ability to use digital devices and the internet effectively, safely, and responsibly — along with the core skills it includes. Second, it highlights useful digital tools for students, such as Google Docs, GitHub, LinkedIn, Canva, and Google Drive. Third, it outlines safe internet practices, including creating strong passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, avoiding phishing links, and using secure (https) websites.

One thing I found interesting while making this was deciding how to arrange information so it remained easy to read without becoming too crowded. Balancing text and visuals in a limited space was more challenging than I expected, and it taught me how important visual hierarchy is in communicating information clearly.

TASK 1: INFORGRAPHCS

DIGITAL LITERACY: YOUR SURVIVAL GUIDE IN THE ONLINE WORLD

What is Digital Literacy?

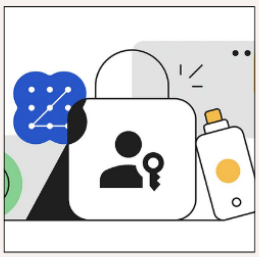
- Digital literacy is the ability to use digital devices, platforms, and the internet effectively, safely, and responsibly
- It includes skills like:
- Searching for reliable information online
- Evaluating whether a source is trustworthy or fake
- Communicating clearly using digital tools (emails, messages, etc.)
- It also means understanding online behavior and ethics, like respecting privacy and avoiding harmful content
- In today's world, being digitally literate is as important as reading and writing

Useful Digital Tools for Students

- Google Docs – assignments & collaboration
- GitHub – projects & coding portfolio
- LinkedIn – professional networking
- Canva – presentations & designs
- Google Drive – cloud storage

Safe Internet Practices

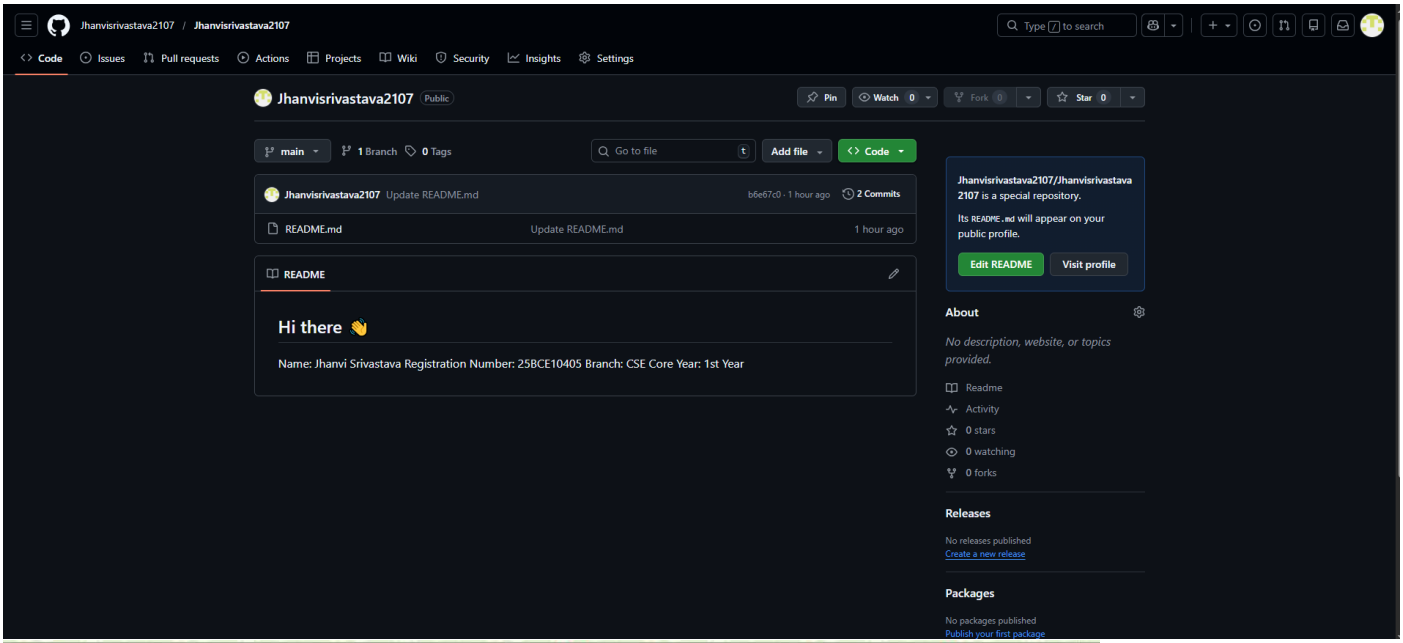
- Create strong, unique passwords using a mix of letters, numbers, and symbols
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) for extra account security
- Avoid clicking on unknown links, suspicious emails, or pop-ups (common phishing traps)
- Do not share personal information like passwords, OTPs, or bank details online
- Use secure websites (https) and trusted platforms for downloads



Task 2 – Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I set up my professional online presence across three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.
GitHub is a platform used for hosting code, managing projects, and building a coding portfolio. I created my profile and set up a README repository that includes my name, branch, year, and a brief introduction about my learning goals. This will serve as my technical portfolio throughout my B.Tech journey.
LinkedIn is a professional networking platform used by students, recruiters, and industry professionals worldwide. I filled in my Education section with my current degree, institution which is VIT Bhopal University, and expected graduation year. I plan to use LinkedIn to connect with professionals, explore internship opportunities, and build my professional presence over time.
Kaggle is a data science and machine learning community platform. I created my profile with a bio describing my background and goals. I plan to use Kaggle to explore datasets and participate in beginner challenges as I grow my technical skills.

Setting up these three profiles made me realise how important a consistent digital presence is, even at the very start of my academic journey.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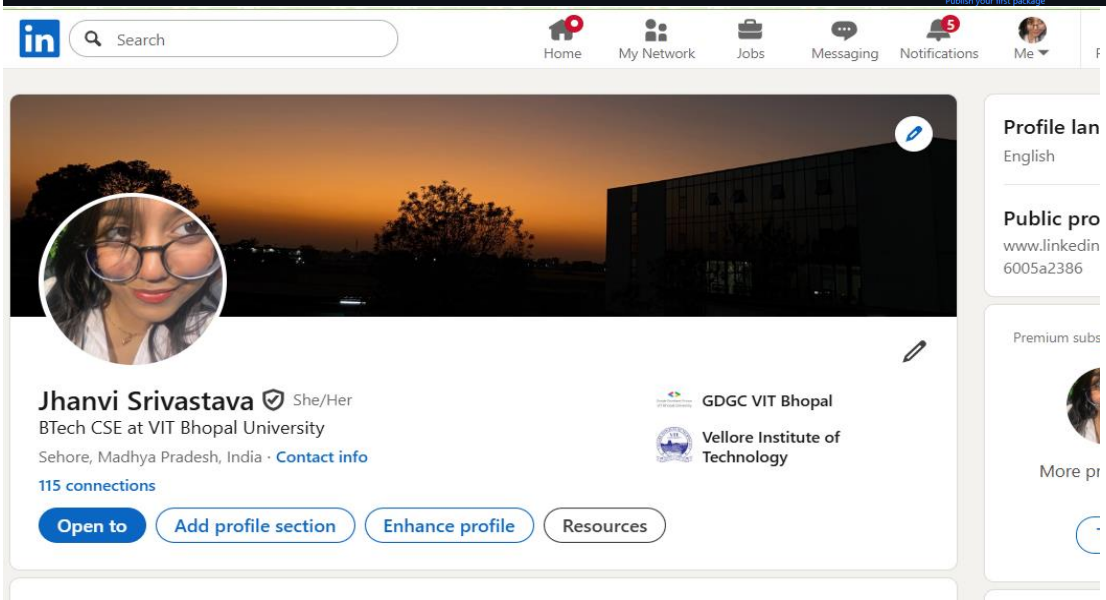
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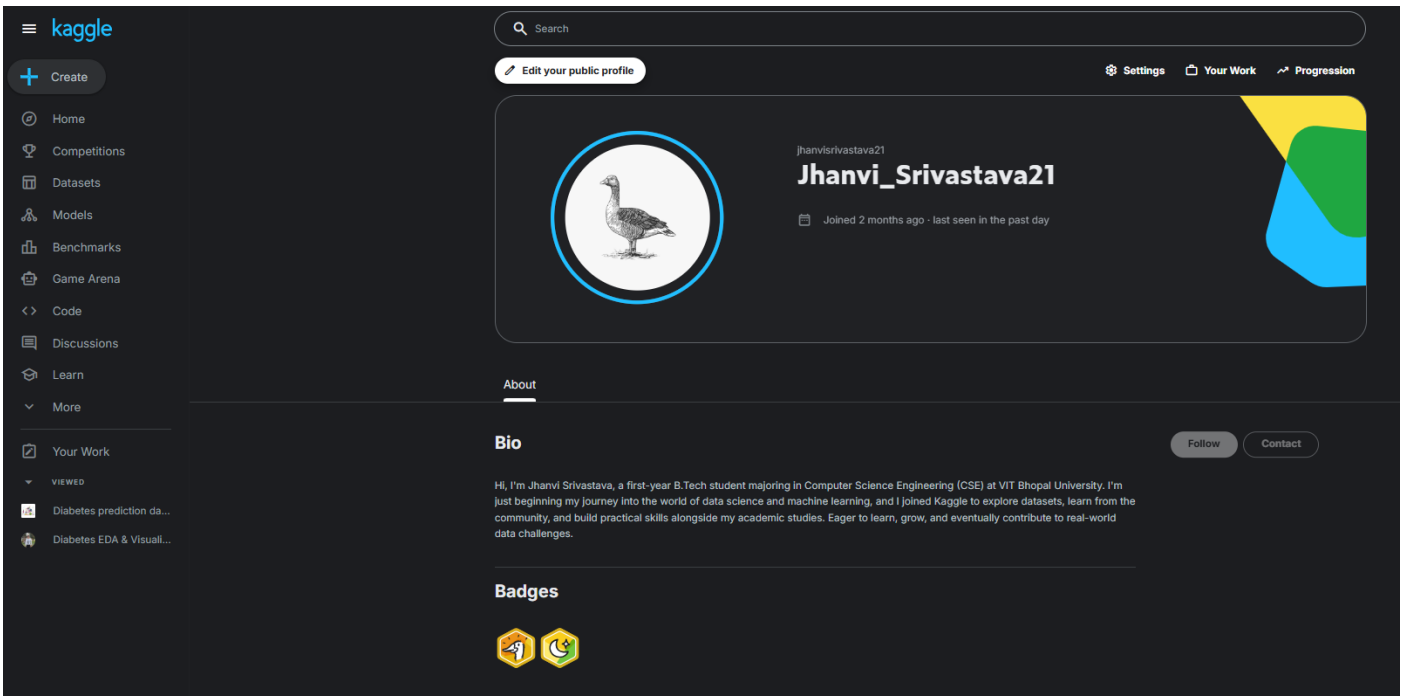
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Hi, I'm Jhanvi Srivastava, a first-year B.Tech student majoring in Computer Science Engineering (CSE) at VIT Bhopal University. I'm just beginning my journey into the world of data science and machine learning, and I joined Kaggle to explore datasets, learn from the community, and build practical skills alongside my academic studies. Eager to learn, grow, and eventually contribute to real-world data challenges.
Badges

Task 3 – Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this task, I explored two types of platforms — one for coding practice and one for collaboration.

I used **HackerRank** to complete a beginner-level problem called "Solve Me First," where I had to take two numbers as input and print their sum. It sounds simple, but it actually helped me understand how coding problems are structured — you read the input, do something with it, and give an output. It also made me more comfortable using an online coding environment for the first time.

For the collaboration part, I created a Google Form titled **"Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz"** with five questions covering topics like online safety, digital tools, and professional communication. I included both multiple-choice and short-answer questions as required. What I found really useful was seeing how the responses automatically get collected into a Google Sheet — it makes managing data so much easier and I can see myself using this for group projects or peer surveys in the future.

Overall, this task was quite practical and I feel like both these tools will genuinely come in handy during my B.Tech years.

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Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz

This quiz tests basic knowledge of digital literacy, online safety, and responsible internet usage.

* Indicates required question

What does Digital Literacy mean? * (1 point)

- (●) Ability to use digital devices effectively
- ( ) Only knowing how to use social media
- ( ) Playing online games
- ( ) Using mobile phones only

Which of the following is a safe internet practice? * (1 point)

- ( ) Sharing passwords with friends
- ( ) Clicking unknown links
- (●) Using strong passwords
- ( ) Downloading from any website

Name one platform used for professional networking. *

Linkedn

What should you include in a professional email? * (1 point)

Preview mode

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- ( ) Downloading from any website

Name one platform used for professional networking. *

Linkedn

What should you include in a professional email? * (1 point)

- ( ) Emojis and slang
- (●) Clear subject line and proper greeting
- ( ) Random text
- ( ) No greeting

Which tool is used for version control and project sharing? * (1 point)

- ( ) Canva
- (●) GitHub
- ( ) WhatsApp
- ( ) Instagram

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Short answer text

Task-4 Poor digital communication caused a real problem

One situation where poor digital communication can cause a real problem is when a student posts frustration about a professor or a college assignment on a public social media account. For example, imagine a student tweets something like "This professor gives impossible deadlines, I'm so done" — not realising their profile is public and the professor follows them. This could seriously damage their academic relationship and even affect how the professor perceives them professionally. The student may not have intended any harm, but the informal and impulsive nature of social media makes it easy to say things without thinking about the consequences. What could have been done differently is simple — either keep such thoughts private, or communicate concerns directly and respectfully to the professor via a professional email. This situation highlights why digital communication etiquette matters just as much as face-to-face communication.

Social Media Do’s and Don’ts checklist:

Do's

1. Keep your profiles professional — use a decent profile photo and a clear bio
2. Think before you post — ask yourself if you'd be comfortable with your professor or future employer seeing it
3. Use privacy settings to control who can see your personal posts
4. Share your achievements, projects, and learning milestones to build a positive online presence
5. Give credit when you share someone else's work, ideas, or content

Don'ts

1. Don't post negative comments about your college, professors, or classmates publicly
2. Don't share personal information like your phone number, address, or daily location
3. Don't engage with or spread unverified news, rumours, or fake information
4. Don't use social media during lectures or important academic activities
5. Don't accept friend/follow requests from people you don't know or trust

Task-5 Cyber Crime Awareness

While researching cybercrime, I was surprised by how easily people can be tricked into sharing sensitive information or approving fraudulent transactions. UPI fraud, in particular, is very common and can happen within seconds due to lack of awareness. I learned that many victims are unaware that entering a UPI PIN is only required to send money, not receive it. This small misunderstanding leads to significant financial losses. One important habit I will change is being more cautious while handling payment requests and verifying sources before taking any action. This task helped me understand the importance of digital awareness and the need to stay alert while using online platforms.